

are also some pre-configured equalisers to be cycled.

On the specifications front, the Thump is available in two versions—128 MB and 256 MB. The Thump supports MP3s, WAV and DRM protected WMA audio formats. A USB 2.0 port is provided for faster transfer of songs and it is even backward compatible with USB 1.1.

A non-removable Lithium-ion battery provides the necessary juice for keeping the audio player running for the claimed six hours. But, with prices starting at \$400 (Rs 17,400) for both versions, Oakley's Thump isn't for shallow pockets.

Fossil PDA Watch

Dick Tracy fans will love Fossil's wrist PDA watch. This rather 'cute' looking device harbours a fully functional PDA based on Palm's OS 4.1. Looks wise, it is hardly distinguishable from a traditional wrist-watch, but speak of functionality, and it has enough features to beat the most hectic schedules without missing any events.

The PDA watch is powered by a Motorola Super VZ 66 MHz Dragonball processor and has 8 MB of RAM; enough for hourglass-free operation! The petite touch screen display has a 160 x 160 pixel resolution offering 16-level greyscale depth and backlighting for viewing in dark.

Inbuilt applications include an address book for contact management; a date book for scheduling; a To Do list; a Memo Pad for taking notes; a calculator. And yes, it also tells time.

These applications apart, the watch can run most Palm software; however, Fossil recommends using specially designed applications to take advantage of the watch navigation system, a rocker switch and larger font set.

For connecting with the PC, the watch comes with a USB port and an Infrared transceiver for communicating with other Palm devices. Power is derived from an internal rechargeable Lithium-ion battery. Fossil claims a battery life of three to four days provided you use it for 30 minutes a day without backlight and IR.

Priced at \$249 (Rs 10,900), Fossil's PDA wristwatch costs as much as a decent PDA from Palm. But it's the size that distinguishes it from the rest. Now, does size really matter?

Adidas_1

Sportswear giant Adidas, a synonym for high quality footwear has introduced a shoe for the geek. The Adidas_1 was conceptualised around 2001 and after

slogging for all these years, Adidas finally managed to get in on the tarmac. So what's tech got to do with a shoe? Well, this is the first shoe with an embedded microprocessor that adapts the shoe cushioning based on the terrain and the user's demand.

While the fact is that no two runners have the same physical characteristics, the same pair of shoes can't always provide the necessary comfort to both. To tackle this problem Adidas_1 can dynamically change the cushioning depending on the terrain, your weight and the speed, to provide the right amount of comfort.

The shoe has a magnetic sensor placed in the heel and monitors any changes in weight, pace and surface type at a rate of 1,000 times per second. This information is then fed to a microprocessor, the brain that determines whether the cushioning is in the ideal zone. If the cushioning is not right, the microprocessor sends a signal to a motor that is connected to a cushioning cylinder in the heel to either relax or tighten depending on whether soft or firm cushioning is required.



Running just got high-tech, thanks to the Adidas_1

There are two buttons on the sides of the shoe, which are required to be pressed simultaneously to switch on the active cushioning system. Moreover, there are five preset levels of cushioning that can be achieved using these two buttons. A small battery powers the entire system and is located under the foot soles of each shoe.

Priced at \$250 (Rs 10,875), the Adidas_1 are a really expensive pair of shoes. Would you really want to get them dirty?

O'Neill's H2 Series Backpack

Energy source is a persistent problem with many portable computing products such as MP3 players, cell phones and other electronics devices. The built-in rechargeable batteries can hardly hold fort for a day and if you are the adven-

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